

STEPHEN SOOKRA

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EDUCATION

Kennesaw State University

B.S. in Computer Science, Concentration in Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning
GPA: 3.8/4.0 | 4× Dean's List

Kennesaw, GA
Expected May 2028

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, C++, C#, Swift

Frameworks: React, React Native, Next.js, FastAPI, LangChain, TensorFlow, scikit-learn, Pandas, NumPy, Unity

Infrastructure: Git, GitHub Actions, Docker, CI/CD, PostgreSQL, ChromaDB, FAISS, Supabase, Vercel, Render, AWS

Concepts: Machine Learning, LLMs & RAG, Vector Search, NLP, Computer Vision, Data Structures & Algorithms, WCAG

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer Intern

Mar 2026 – Present

XR Dojo

Atlanta, GA

- Shipped gameplay features for *ATL Quest*, an AR mobile game in Unity (C#) targeting XR headsets and mobile.
- Ported a Unity mini-game to React Three Fiber with Rapiere physics to evaluate a browser-based cross-platform path.
- Built the Next.js app shell, a marker-based phone AR mode, and a camera-free preview for demos without the physical site.

Founder & Project Lead

Jan 2026 – Present

Nest (Non-Profit Initiative)

Atlanta, GA

- Founded and led a 3-person team building a retrieval-augmented navigator that turns Georgia's 250-page DFCS transition manual into personalized 90-day plans for youth aging out of foster care.
- Built the React/Vite front end and owned the Render deploy; the FastAPI service retrieves passages from a ChromaDB vector store via LangChain, reranks them against the youth's profile, then generates with Llama 3.3 on Groq.
- Answered a showcase reviewer's challenge on wrong eligibility info with a fail-closed path: zero retrieved passages means the model is never called and the user gets a deterministic 211 Georgia referral.

Data Analyst — HBCU Data for Good

Apr 2026

JPMorganChase

Plano, TX

- Earned one of 110 seats from 800+ applicants for JPMorganChase's Data for Good, HBCU Student Edition.
- Ranked all 357 Tarrant County census tracts for the Fort Worth Community Land Trust using a weighted 8-metric model in pandas, normalizing each metric with scikit-learn MinMaxScaler across 6 HUD datasets.
- Layered OpenStreetMap amenities and Census TIGER boundaries into an interactive map; a flood-corridor overlay cut recommended acquisition targets from 47 tracts to 34.

Teaching Assistant

Summer 2026

SMASH Academy

Atlanta, GA

- Taught Python, JavaScript, and web/game development to underrepresented high-school scholars at Morehouse and Spelman.

PROJECTS

Lullabuy | *Next.js, TypeScript, Visa Acceptance, CLIP, transformers.js, Gemini, Expo* | [Live Demo](#)

Sep 2026

- Co-built (team of 2) a resale checkout that holds a Visa payment until a label photo clears 1,207 CPSC/NHTSA recalls.
- Trained an in-browser CLIP classifier for banned products (held-out macro-F1 0.72 vs. 0.56 zero-shot) and built the web and Expo mobile clients. **Won the \$5,000 Visa track**, HackGT 13.

Aloud | *Next.js, TypeScript, OpenAI Realtime, YouCam Skin Analysis API, MediaPipe, Capacitor* | [Live Demo](#)

Aug 2026

- Built a voice-first skincare assistant blind shoppers use screen-off: barcode ingredient reads and MediaPipe audio-guided selfies.
- Grounded every spoken skin read in YouCam analysis scores, gated CI with a linter that blocks medical claims, and shipped web, iOS, and Android from one codebase. **Won 1st of 238 and \$5,000**, YouCam API Hackathon.

VARSITY | *Next.js, TypeScript, Python, FastAPI, IBM watsonx Granite, FAISS* | [Live Demo](#)

Jun 2026

- Built a screen-reader-native explainer narrating VAR and offside margins for blind fans from StatsBomb tracking data.
- Parsed the IFAB Laws with Docling into a FAISS index (Hit@5 = 1.00); watsonx Granite drafts the prose and a deterministic gate rejects any answer that fails to cite the governing Law, so the model is never the last word.
- Built solo in 159 CI-gated PRs. **Won IBM's \$5,000 Grand Prize** and **Most Innovative** of 98 teams.

StepSafe | *TensorFlow, MobileNetV2, FastAPI, React, Vite* | [Live Demo](#)

Mar 2026

- Built a classifier that scores diabetic foot ulcer severity from a photo and returns clinical guidance.
- Fine-tuned MobileNetV2, a mobile-scale CNN, on ~20,000 images behind FastAPI. **Won 1st Place**, HMI Hackathon 2026.

CERTIFICATIONS

CodePath — Web Development · **AT&T Technology Academy 2025** · **Udacity** — AWS AI Practitioner Challenge

Anthropic Academy 2026 — AI Fluency, Claude 101, Claude Code 101, Claude API, MCP, Agent Skills

AWARDS

17 awards across 15 events (25+ entered). Also: **1st of 22**, Actian (Trace) · **1st + \$2,000**, BIT Code for Change (Upstander) · **1st**, ToC Chaos Challenge (Parliament) · **Best Use of Technology, \$750**, IBM AI Builders (Manifest) · **Most Innovative, \$750**, IBM AI Builders (AccessGate) · **Best Use of Gemma 4**, Hack RenderATL (Throughline) · **2nd of 4,700+**, Wells Fargo × GCA (SafeHaven) · **2nd**, Rote Playoffs · **2nd + 3rd**, KSU Social Good (PyroLens) · **3rd**, KSU FinTech (EchoPay) · **3rd**, Vibra ATL (Saber)